Tax Records Retention and Audit Trail

Halide Labs — Internal Policy · Policy ID: HL-TAX-POL-007 · Owner: Controller, with Senior Manager, Tax · Effective: 1 July 2026 · Version 1.0

> FICTIONAL COMPANY POLICY FOR DEMO PURPOSES. Halide Labs is a fictional company. Retention periods here are company standards, not statements of law.

1. What is kept

Record	Where	Company retention standard
Supplier and customer invoices	ERP document store	7 years after the end of the fiscal year
Tax determination lines (rule ID, rate, base, treatment)	tax data warehouse	7 years
Proposed tax journals, approvals and rejections	close desk (AGENT schema)	7 years
Audit log of every proposal, flag and approval, including those by the AI assistant	AGENT.AUDIT_LOG	7 years
AI assistant conversations and traces	agent monitoring / observability	1 year, or longer if linked to an approved entry
Exemption certificates and registrations	tax data warehouse	life of certificate + 7 years

Tax may extend any period while an audit, inquiry or refund claim is open in a jurisdiction. Where local law requires longer retention, the longer period applies.

2. Audit trail requirements

- Every tax journal proposal records: preparer (user and role), time, source document, amounts in minor units and currency, rule IDs used, and the policy cited.
- Every approval or rejection records the approver, time and comment. A record is never edited after approval; corrections are new proposals.
- AI-assisted work is labelled as such in the audit log so a reviewer can tell which proposals an AI assistant prepared.

3. Deletion

Records past retention are deleted only after Tax confirms there is no open audit, inquiry or refund claim for the period.